

Peer-review (with Kyle):

A key observation from the role-playing session was how the conversation is initiated. The original design relied on the user starting the interaction with a specific prompt (e.g., "Word bot, what is today's word?"). To avoid the guessing game of what the device could do, I began the interaction by asking, "Hello, would you like today's word?"

This introduced a new design consideration: should a non-critical tool proactively engage the user? A calculator or weather app doesn't need to, but a language-learning app, like Duolingo, would. One way to implement this could be with a proximity sensor that detects when the user is near. It also raises practical questions: how often should it activate, and would it become intrusive?

During the dialogue, the structured responses were an advantage. However, there was a slight pause after giving the definition and example, likely because the user was unsure how to continue or about the Wordbot's capabilities. One solution could be to provide a short response followed by "Would you like me to continue?" or a summary followed by "Would you like more information on its origin?"